



Health Literacy and Associated Factors among The University Students in Bangladesh

Abdul Mazed, Shorful Alam Akib

Department of Statistics, Shahjalal University of Science and Technology, Sylhet-3114, Bangladesh

Introduction

Health literacy refers to the skills and knowledge individuals need to effectively access, understand, and utilize health information in order to make basic health decision. Low health literacy leads to negative health outcomes, such as increased hospitalizations and emergency services, reduced preventative health services, and an unhealthy lifestyle, which are costly and harmful to society. Thus, an adequate level of health literacy among the general population is undoubtably an important issue for a country. Young adults, such as university students, comprise a significant portion of the general population and play a vital part in a country's development. Moreover, university life may have negative effects on the mental health of students, and health behavior including quality of life, leading to health problems or even death. Therefore, students' health literacy level should be evaluated, so that problematic issues can be addressed appropriately.

Objective:

- ❑ To evaluate the health literacy level of university students in Bangladesh .
- ❑ To identify socio-demographic factors that influence students' health literacy.

Methodology

- ❑ An Online based cross-sectional study was conduct on the university students in Bangladesh.
- ❑ A total of 391 observations have been included from 41 different public and private universities.
- ❑ HLS-EU-Q47 questionnaire has been used to measure the health literacy along with the socio-economic and demographic questionnaire.
- ❑ Descriptive statistics, analysis of covariance(ANOVA), t-Test is used to measure the health literacy and the associate factors.
- ❑ Multivariate regression technique is also used .to determine the effects of associated factors .

Result and Discussion

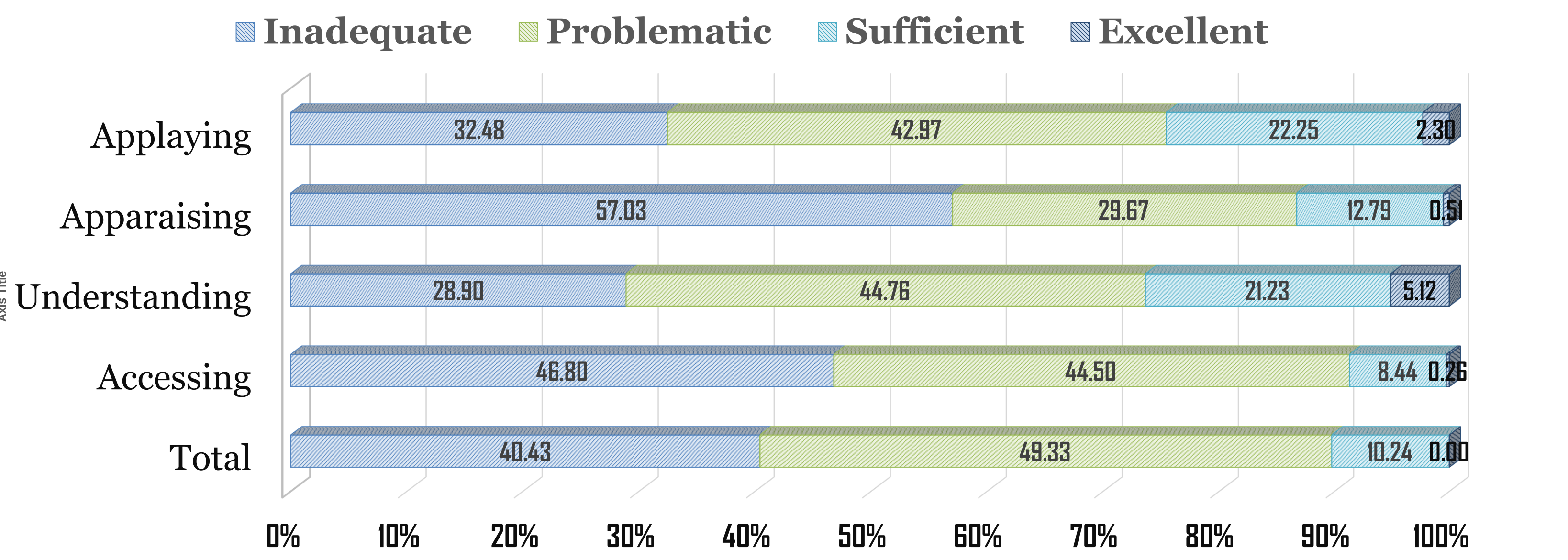


Figure 1: Levels of general health literacy and levels of health literacy on four Domains.

Table: Association between HL level and sociodemographic characteristic

Factors	Label	Mean	SD	P-value
Gender	Male	26.11	5.31	0.16
	Female	26.94	5.62	
University Type	Public	26.19	5.44	0.02
	Private	28.62	4.61	
Academic year	1st Year	27.54	5.94	0.31
	2nd Year	26.14	5.29	
	3rd Year	26.52	5.00	
	4 Year	25.71	5.92	
	5th year/Masters	26.54	3.94	
Hometown Area	Rural	26.10	5.59	0.27
	Urban	26.71	5.20	
Current residence	Hall	25.20	5.66	0.02
	Mess	26.51	5.42	
	Own residence	27.48	4.87	

Conclusion and Recommendation

The health literacy of the university student is not at the desired level. Improved health literacy among university students has the potential to improve their overall health and well-being, as well as the health of their communities. Therefore Universities and health organizations must work together to provide students with the resources they need to develop the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required to make informed decisions about their health.

Factors	Label	Mean	SD	P-value
Mothers education	Illiterate	24.66	5.45	0.14
	Primary	26.37	4.90	
	Secondary	26.46	5.25	
	Higher Secondary	25.94	5.60	
	Higher	27.50	5.61	
Family Income	<20k	25.57	5.37	0.43
	20-40k	26.96	5.75	
	40-60k	26.55	4.93	
	60-80k	25.49	6.37	
	80-100k	26.50	3.97	
	100k<	27.00	5.42	
History of severe disease	Yes	25.98	5.15	0.35
	No	26.54	5.53	
Smoking	Yes	24.88	5.24	0.05
	No	26.55	5.42	

Table2: Coefficient of regression Model

Model	Unstandardized Coefficients		t	Sig.	95.0% Confidence Interval for B	
	B	Std. Error			Lower Bound	Upper Bound
Constant	27.663	1.222	22.629	0.000	25.260	30.067
Gender	-0.847	0.618	-1.371	0.171	-2.061	0.367
University type	-1.915	1.059	-1.809	0.071	-3.996	0.166
Smoking	-1.344	0.894	-1.504	0.133	-3.102	0.413
Mess	1.509	0.667	2.262	0.024	0.197	2.821
Own residence	1.888	0.826	2.287	0.023	0.265	3.511

- The R Squared value is 0.042.
- Dependent variable : Health literacy score.

ANOVA

Model	Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Regression	483.896	5.000	96.779	3.401	.005
Residual	10954.379	385.000	28.453		
Total	11438.275	390.000			

- Almost half of the students (49.1%) had problematic Health Literacy, 40.9% had inadequate health literacy, and only 10% had sufficient health literacy. But none of the students had excellent health literacy.
- From table 1 we see that students health literacy varies for their socio-demographic and economic characteristic. Among the factors university type, current place of residence, and smoking habit had been found significant.
- The regression analysis shows that comparing to hall students who lives in mess have 1.51 unit and who lives in their own residence have 1.88 unit higher health literacy score holding other variables constant.